

Christopher Columbus

The EXPLORER

who stumbled across the New World

Christopher Columbus is known as “the man who discovered America,” even though he didn’t really know what he had discovered!

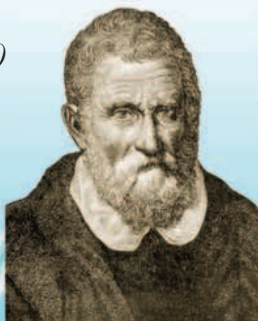
Wind in his sails

Christopher Columbus was born in 1451 in Genoa, Italy. He was **just a teenager** when he was first sent to sea, and after lots of traveling he made Portugal his home. Intrigued by the **spices and gold** on offer in the parts of the Far East, Columbus believed that he could find a quicker sea route to reach there. So at a time when most explorers sailed east toward the Far East, Columbus came up with a plan to search for it by **SAILING WEST**.

Columbus took three ships on the voyage—the Santa Maria, the Pinta, and the Niña.

He couldn't have done it without...

The remarkable adventures of **MARCO POLO** (1254–1324) in China helped to open up valuable trade routes to the Far East.



Columbus got the money he needed for his expedition from Spain's **KING FERDINAND** (1452–1516) and **QUEEN ISABELLA** (1451–1504).

